

Fixing the VPS Git Update Error

Safe instructions for the “local changes would be overwritten by merge” error

REPOSITORY FOLDER
`/var/www/mshauri`

CONFLICTING FILE
`pnpm-workspace.yaml`

Error shown on the VPS:

```
error: Your local changes to the following files would be overwritten by merge:
  pnpm-workspace.yaml
Please commit your changes or stash them before you merge.
Aborting
```

What this means

The VPS has a local edit to `pnpm-workspace.yaml`. GitHub also has a newer version of that file. Git stops the update instead of silently deleting the VPS edit.

This file is part of the application source code. VPS-only settings such as passwords, Clerk keys, session secrets and the Owner email belong in `deploy/.env.production`, not in `pnpm-workspace.yaml`.

Recommended safe fix

1

Enter the Mshauri folder

```
cd /var/www/mshauri
```

2

Back up the local change

This saves a copy outside the repository before restoring the GitHub version.

```
git diff -- pnpm-workspace.yaml > /root/pnpm-workspace-local-change.diff
ls -lh /root/pnpm-workspace-local-change.diff
```

3

Confirm the file is the only change

```
git status --short
```

You should see `pnpm-workspace.yaml` as the conflicting modified file.

4

Restore only the conflicting source file

```
git restore pnpm-workspace.yaml
```

This does not remove `deploy/.env.production` because that file is separate and should remain local to the VPS.

5

Run the normal update

```
bash deploy/3-update.sh
```

The script pulls the current code, installs packages, builds the application, applies database changes and restarts the API.

After the update

Check that the API restarted successfully:

```
pm2 status  
pm2 logs mshauri-api --lines 50
```

Check the website:

```
curl -I https://mshauri.marichomedia.com
```

Then open the website in a browser and sign in.

If the error appears again

Run these commands and review all modified files:

```
cd /var/www/mshauri  
git status --short  
git diff --stat
```

Stop if files other than `pnpm-workspace.yaml` are modified. Do not restore or delete those files until their purpose is confirmed. In particular, do not delete `deploy/.env.production` or any advert upload directory.

Do not use this shortcut

```
git reset --hard
```

Do not use a hard reset as the first fix. It can delete local tracked changes and make recovery harder. The recommended procedure backs up and restores only the known conflicting file.

Optional: inspect the saved change

```
less /root/pnpm-workspace-local-change.diff
```

If the file contains a useful project change that should be kept, send the diff to the developer for review rather than editing it directly on the production VPS.

Quick version

```
cd /var/www/mshauri
git diff -- pnpm-workspace.yaml > /root/pnpm-workspace-local-change.diff
git restore pnpm-workspace.yaml
bash deploy/3-update.sh
pm2 status
```